

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Marxism, Scientific Socialism and Core Vocabulary

CENTRAL FOCUS

Marxism, Scientific Socialism and Core Vocabulary

- [1] Marxism: a set of political and economic principles founded by Marx and Engels to give socialism a scientific basis through historical analysis of conflict between antagonistic classes. (PDF p.47)

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- [2] Classical Marxism: the original scientific system centred on property, class division, contradiction and revolutionary transformation. (PDF p.47)

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- [3] Gauba presents classical Marxism through four main tenets: dialectical materialism, historical materialism, class conflict and surplus value. (PDF p.48, p.52)

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- [4] Marxism explains why formal legal equality can coexist with deep economic inequality under capitalism. (PDF pp.46-47)

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- [5] Neo-Marxism shows why domination cannot be reduced only to factory ownership; culture, communication and ideology also matter. (PDF pp.53-54)

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SYNTHESIS -> Marxism, Scientific Socialism and Core Vocabulary is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: The Classical Marxist Argument and Essential Distinctions

CENTRAL FOCUS

The Classical Marxist Argument and Essential Distinctions

- [1] Classical Marxism vs neo-Marxism: classical Marxism emphasizes property, class contradiction and revolution; neo-Marxism widens the lens to ideology, culture and new forms of domination. (PDF pp.47, 53-54)

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- [2] Gauba begins with capitalism's oppressive conditions and presents Marxism as a response to the failure of laissez-faire liberalism to deliver real human freedom. (PDF pp.46-47)

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- [3] Marxism argues that private property in the means of production divides society into dominant and dependent classes with antagonistic interests. (PDF p.47)

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- [4] The mode of production shapes the social structure; when productive forces clash with existing relations of production, revolution replaces one social formation with another. (PDF pp.48-50)

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- [5] Class struggle continues from slave society to feudalism to capitalism, and Marxism expects a socialist revolution to end this cycle in a classless society. (PDF pp.49-52)

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SYNTHESIS -> The Classical Marxist Argument and Essential Distinctions is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Thinkers, Illustrations and the Three-Strand Matrix

CENTRAL FOCUS

Thinkers, Illustrations and the Three-Strand Matrix

[1] Marx and Engels: founders of Marxism and scientific socialism; they treat history as struggle rooted in the mode of production. (PDF p.47)

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[2] Lenin, Rosa Luxemburg and Mao Zedong: Gauba lists them among chief exponents of classical Marxism. (PDF p.47)

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[3] Young Marx: Gauba highlights the early humanist Marx on alienation, freedom and capitalism's dehumanizing effects. (PDF p.47)

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[4] Frankfurt School: Adorno, Horkheimer, Marcuse and Habermas extend Marxism through critical theory and ideology critique. (PDF p.53)

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[5] Herbert Marcuse: argues that advanced bourgeois society reduces human beings to one-dimensionality by anaesthetizing discontent through manipulated desires. (PDF p.54)

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SYNTHESIS -> Thinkers, Illustrations and the Three-Strand Matrix is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Ownership Boundaries and UPSC Trap Repair

CENTRAL FOCUS

Ownership Boundaries and UPSC Trap Repair

- [1] Forces of production vs relations of production: forces include means of production plus labour power; relations concern ownership patterns and class relations.

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- [2] Human problem: Exploitation rooted in ownership of means of production.

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- [3] Mode of production: forces of production (means of production plus labour power/technique) combine with relations of production (ownership patterns and class relations) to form the economic base (Gaub, PDF pp.48-49).

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- [4] Fetter/rupture mechanism: when the forces of production (technique, productive capacity) develop beyond what the existing relations of production (ownership patterns) can accommodate, the relations become a fetter on further development; revolution breaks that fetter and replaces one social formation with another across the stage-sequence slave-owning → feudal → capitalist → socialist/communist (Gaub, PDF p.49).

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SYNTHESIS -> Ownership Boundaries and UPSC Trap Repair is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Historical Materialism Without Mechanical Determinism

CENTRAL FOCUS

Historical Materialism Without Mechanical Determinism

- [1] Historical materialism restated as a mechanism: economic relations of production, distribution and exchange play the decisive role in shaping wider social and political life (Gaub, PDF p.48).

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- [2] Show class struggle across historical stages and end with proletarian revolution. (PDF pp.49-52)

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- [3] Base-superstructure – non-mechanical: the base is the mode of production; the superstructure is law, politics, religion, morals, art and culture. Gaub's own neo-Marxist section explicitly records growing recognition of interdependence between base and superstructure, rejecting a crude, one-way, mechanical determination of the superstructure by the base (Gaub, PDF pp.48, 53).

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- [4] Start with Marxism as scientific socialism responding to capitalist exploitation. (PDF pp.46-47)

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- [5] Explain base, superstructure, forces of production and relations of production clearly. (PDF pp.48-49)

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SYNTHESIS -> Historical Materialism Without Mechanical Determinism is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Class, State, Exploitation and Alienation

CENTRAL FOCUS

Class, State, Exploitation and Alienation

- [1] Read together: exploitation (surplus value), domination (state as class instrument) and dehumanization (alienation) are three faces of the same underlying property relation, not three unrelated Marxist claims – a strong answer connects them rather than listing them separately.

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- [2] Class: private property in the means of production divides society into dominant (owning) and dependent classes with antagonistic interests, driving conflict across historical stages toward an expected socialist/classless resolution (Gaub, PDF pp.47, 49-52).

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- [3] Alienation: the "Young Marx"/humanist strain of neo-Marxism centres on alienation, freedom and capitalism's dehumanizing effects on the worker (Gaub, PDF p.47). The mechanism: wage-labour separates the worker from the product of labour and from the labour process itself, and, in humanist readings, from a fully developed human nature and from fellow workers – a separation that operates even before any single surplus-value calculation is made.

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SYNTHESIS -> Class, State, Exploitation and Alienation is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

CENTRAL FOCUS

Gramsci and the Frankfurt School

- [1] Antonio Gramsci – cross-referenced from Gauba's treatment of hegemony in the power/authority chapter (Gauba, PDF pp.306, 309-311), rather than from the Marxism chapter's own PDF pp.46-54 range – adds hegemony, civil society and structures of legitimation to explain why capitalist rule survives through consent as well as coercion: capitalist class power is secured not only through the coercive state but through cultural and ideological leadership exercised in civil society.

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- [2] This is a genuine neo-Marxist departure: Gramsci gives relative autonomy to the superstructure (culture, ideas, civil-society institutions) rather than treating it as simply base-determined, extending the non-mechanical base-superstructure point of §12.

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- [3] Adorno, Horkheimer, Marcuse and Habermas are named together by Gauba as extending Marxism through critical theory and ideology critique (Gauba, PDF p.53).

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SYNTHESIS -> Gramsci and the Frankfurt School is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Althusser, Dependency Theory and Classification Cautions

CENTRAL FOCUS

Althusser, Dependency Theory and Classification Cautions

- [1] Louis Althusser represents the "scientific" strain of neo-Marxism, resisting a purely humanist Marxism and insisting on analysing deep social structures, especially modes of production, rather than centring alienation and consciousness (Gaub, PDF p.54).

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- [2] Gaub's own text names "dependency theorists" as extending the axis of Marxist struggle from domestic class conflict to developing nations confronting colonialism and neo-colonialism (Gaub, PDF p.54).

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SYNTHESIS -> Althusser, Dependency Theory and Classification Cautions is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Objections, Qualified Thesis, Evidence and Doctrine Architecture

CENTRAL FOCUS

Objections, Qualified Thesis, Evidence and Doctrine Architecture

[1] Premises: (a) private property in the means of production divides society into antagonistic classes (Gaub, PDF p.47); (b) the mode of production – forces plus relations of production – forms the base, shaping law, politics and culture as superstructure (Gaub, PDF p.48); (c) productive forces and relations of production can come into conflict (Gaub, PDF p.49).

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[2] Mechanism: when forces of production outgrow existing relations of production, the relations become a fetter that is broken by revolution, producing a new social formation (§12); this economic-class mechanism operates through and is reproduced by state power as a class instrument (§13) and is experienced by individuals as alienation (§13). Neo-Marxists (§14) extend the mechanism by adding culture/hegemony (Gramsci), critical theory (Frankfurt School), structural analysis (Althusser) and international core-periphery relations (dependency theory) as additional – not substitute – sites where the same underlying property-based conflict is reproduced or contested.

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SYNTHESIS -> Objections, Qualified Thesis, Evidence and Doctrine Architecture is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Indian Application, Mark-Scaled Answers and Proposition Discipline

CENTRAL FOCUS

Indian Application, Mark-Scaled Answers and Proposition Discipline

- [1] When an Indian policy debate is framed only as a technical/administrative matter, the non-mechanical base-superstructure relation (§12) and Gramscian hegemony (§14.1) together supply the question of whether an apparently neutral legal or administrative arrangement is doing quiet work to protect an existing economic arrangement – to be paired with the candidate's own independently verified Polity/Economy facts, not asserted here.

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- [2] The Habermas generation caveat (§14.2) and the dependency/world-systems classification caution (§14.4) are flagged specifically because they are standard scholarly clarifications, not independently page-anchored against the Marxism chapter's own PDF pp.46-54 range; do not upgrade them to status or attach a specific book title/year/page without independent verification.

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- [3] Primary source used directly: O. P. Gauba, An Introduction to Political Theory, Fifth Edition (2009), Ch.2, PDF pp.46-54, with a cross-chapter Gramsci anchor at PDF pp.306, 309-311 (power/authority chapter).

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SYNTHESIS -> Indian Application, Mark-Scaled Answers and Proposition Discipline is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair

CENTRAL FOCUS

MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair

- [1] Marxism: a set of political and economic principles founded by Marx and Engels to give socialism a scientific basis through historical analysis of conflict between antagonistic classes.

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- [2] Classical Marxism: the original scientific system centred on property, class division, contradiction and revolutionary transformation.

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- [3] Neo-Marxism: later Marxist thought that studies subtler forms of dominance, alienation and paths to human emancipation.

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- [4] Dialectical materialism: the view that matter, not idea, is fundamental, and that contradictions in material conditions drive development.

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SYNTHESIS -> MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

CENTRAL FOCUS

PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice

- [1] The consistency argument. If the means of production are brought under genuinely social, democratic control, then the structural coercion of the wage-relation is removed and freedom is EXTENDED to those the market subordinated -- collective ownership is the condition, not the enemy, of real freedom.

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- [2] Reframe "freedom". Marx rejects a purely negative liberty (non-interference) that leaves formal rights operating over radically unequal social conditions. His positive ideal is non-domination PLUS self-development: the capacity to engage in conscious, social, creative activity, of which alienated labour deprives the worker (evidence P3 -- estrangement from product, activity, species-being and others).

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- [3] What the free market vindicates in Marx. Concentration of capital, commodification, precarity, recurrent crises and the ideological normalisation of market relations remain live phenomena the analysis still explains (evidence P2 -- the contradiction between developing forces and existing relations; P4 -- structural exploitation through surplus value, argued as a relation, not via the contested price theory).

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SYNTHESIS -> PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.